

6. PROJECT DEVELOPMENT PHASE

6.1 Introduction

The Project Development Phase involves implementing the planned Incident Management functionality in the ServiceNow instance.

The development activities follow the design and implementation plan defined during the previous phases.

6.2 Service Configuration

The required service and service offering are configured as part of the ServiceNow implementation.

The service structure provides the foundation for connecting incidents with the appropriate service information.

6.3 Incident Creation

An incident is created using the Service Operations Workspace.

The incident contains information such as:

- Caller
- Short Description
- Description
- Service
- Category
- Subcategory
- Impact
- Urgency
- Assignment Group
- Assigned To

After submitting the incident, ServiceNow generates an incident number that can be used for tracking.

6.4 Incident Classification

The created incident is classified according to the type and nature of the issue.

Category and subcategory provide information about the type of incident, while service and CI information identify the affected service or configuration item.

Impact and urgency are used to determine the appropriate priority.

6.5 Knowledge Integration

Knowledge Management is integrated into the incident investigation process.

The support agent can search the available knowledge content for possible solutions related to the reported issue.

This reduces the need to investigate every incident from the beginning and allows existing troubleshooting information to be reused.

6.6 Reassignment and Escalation

If the initial Service Desk team cannot resolve an incident, the incident is reassigned to an appropriate support group.

For complex incidents, the incident can be escalated to Level 2 support.

The Level 2 technician receives the incident with the available information and performs further investigation.

6.7 Level 2 Incident Investigation

The Level 2 support team investigates the incident and updates the record with relevant work notes and status information.

The technician can review the original incident description, classification, knowledge information, related records, and other available details.

6.8 Emergency Change Request

If resolving the incident requires an urgent modification to the IT environment, an Emergency Change Request is created.

The change record is associated with the incident so that the relationship between the problem and the required change remains traceable.

6.9 Child Incident Creation

For related or recurring issues, child incidents are created under the appropriate parent incident.

This allows individual incidents to be tracked separately while maintaining their relationship with the main incident.

6.10 Incident Resolution

After investigation and troubleshooting, the Level 2 support team documents the cause and resolution.

The incident is then moved through the configured resolution process.

Resolution information should clearly explain how the issue was addressed so that it can be useful for future incidents.

6.11 Knowledge Article Creation

Resolution information from useful incidents can be converted into Knowledge Articles.

These articles provide reusable troubleshooting information for Service Desk agents and support teams.

This creates a continuous improvement cycle:

Incident → Resolution → Knowledge Article → Future Incident Resolution

6.12 SLA and Related Record Tracking

SLA information and related records are reviewed as part of the incident lifecycle.

The implementation validates that the incident has the required related information and that SLA-related details can be tracked.

6.13 Notifications

Notifications can be used to inform relevant users or support teams when important incident events occur.

Examples include:

- Incident creation
- Assignment
- Reassignment
- Escalation
- Status changes
- Resolution

The purpose is to improve communication and ensure that responsible teams are aware of important changes in the incident lifecycle.